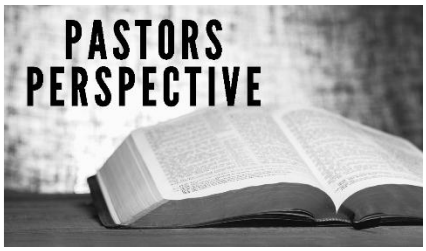
October 2026 Volume 30, Issue 10

# THE ROCKY HOCK ANCHOR

**The Mission of Rocky Hock Baptist Church is to magnify Christ and make disciples of all people.**




## "That Good 'Ole Stream Of Consciousness!"

**Proverbs 3:27** – *"Withhold not good from them to whom it is due, when it is in the power of thine hand to do it."*

[What you are about to experience is the "stream of consciousness" of your Pastor from the early morning moments of September 23, 2026, at 5:00 AM. All of the following content took place within about 2-3 minutes].

It's amazing how many thoughts can race through our minds when we first wake up. *Before our feet even hit the floor — we can walk through an entire day, in our minds, in just a few seconds.* During those early morning hours… it's easy to get into a "stream of consciousness" — where one thought leads to another thought, which leads to another thought, and so on! Before long, it's hard to remember where you even started.

*It was that way for me this morning.* I woke up around 5 AM to the news that one of my childhood mentors, Rev. Johnny Foster — who spoke at our Spring Revival back in April — had a massive heart attack due to a 100% blockage in one of his arteries. I immediately reached out to the Fosters and learned that Johnny was okay, and there was no major damage to his heart. As you can imagine, they were praising the Lord!

Shortly after speaking with them — *thanks to that good 'ole stream of consciousness* — my mind turned to thoughts of revival, and I began to feel a sense of excitement and urgency for the meetings ahead (Oct. 4-7). I prayed for God to *stir hearts* and *strengthen* our church. And I thought about our guest speaker — another man of God from the mountains who made a profound impact on my life — Rev. Keith Nuckolls. Mr. Nuckolls was my Middle School Vice Principal, Baseball Coach, and High School Principal, and he has been pastoring in the town I grew up in for nearly 30 years. We're excited to welcome him and his wife Carla (a lifelong school teacher) to Rocky Hock!

Within seconds of thinking about our Fall Revival — *thanks to that good 'ole stream of consciousness* — my mind turned to my ordination ceremony — an event that both Rev. Johnny Foster and Mr. Nuckolls attended. And I thought about all of the faces I remember seeing in that room - 36 ordained men of God who had devoted their entire lives to serving the Lord and shepherding His people 24/7. Men like my Pawpaw — who faithfully pastored for over 65 years until his death. Men like my Dad, who has pastored for 48 years and counting. People like Mr. Nuckolls, who has served at the same church in my hometown for almost 20 years. Men like Rev. Johnny Foster — who gave me my first commentary book as a young preacher. As I continued to scan the room in my mind, I saw example after example of faithfulness.

Soon after this — *thanks to that good 'ole stream of consciousness* — my mind was drawn towards another faithful man of God, who served as the Pastor of our church over 30 years ago — *Rev. Donald Wagner.* Not too long ago, I found out that he was still living — and since October is Pastor Appreciation Month — I decided to get in touch with him. Thanks to Ms. Carol Shutt and his daughter Becky, I succeeded! And I was able to have an exceptionally good phone conversation with him. As the Pastor of our church, I felt it was my duty to reach out to him and let him know that we were praying for him, and he hadn't been forgotten. *He told me to let y'all know that he was grateful to have served here so many years ago and he sends his best from Burlington, NC.*

Around this time in the story… at about 5:03 AM… my mind *finally* slowed down, and a deep sense of gratitude welled up in my soul. I'm *thankful* for all of the people who showed me Jesus. I'm thankful that Rev. Johnny Foster is going to be okay. I'm thankful that Mr. Nuckolls will be here soon and that another revival is right around the corner.

*(continued on page 2)*

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I'm thankful that I was able to speak with one of our former Pastors last week and send our regards. *And I'm thankful for all the folks who have poured into my life over the years*! So thankful, in fact, that I decided to do something special this month, and I'm going to challenge you to do it, as well! In the month of October, let's make a *special effort* to reach out to all the people who have poured into our lives over the years, and say, "Thank you." *Through phone calls or notes of appreciation, etc.!*

Let's reach out to all those spiritual leaders and Sunday School teachers who are still alive and give them their flowers while they're still here. If God brings them to your mind… *there must be a reason for it!*

**Pastor Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor**

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## Cache` Hapner
## Candidate for Director of Family & Children's Ministries

Cache` Hapner, Ed.D., is an educator, mentor, community volunteer, and retired U.S. Navy Chief Petty Officer with more than 20 years of experience developing people, building teams, teaching, and serving communities. She holds a Doctor of Education in Organizational Leadership. Currently, she teaches at College of the Albemarle, where she develops curriculum, mentors students, and works with community and industry partners to expand educational opportunities. During her Navy career, Cache` served in various leadership positions, including instructor and senior training leader.

Service has been a consistent part of Cache's life. Her experience includes Drug Education for Youth (DEFY), leading volunteers in school programs and improvement projects, teaching in a GED program, supporting senior citizens and homeless veterans, and numerous community-service initiatives. Her sustained volunteer service earned two Military Outstanding Volunteer Service Medals, as well as Navy League and congressional recognition.

Most importantly, Cache` is grateful for her beautiful family. She and her husband, Dan — who is the Deputy Director of Submarine Communication Systems for VTG Defense — have three children and are still raising their two youngest, Delilah and Dylan, and their family has enjoyed becoming part of the Rocky Hock church community. Cache` has served through Vacation Bible School, handbells, and other church service opportunities. Raised in the Baptist church, she accepted Jesus Christ as her Lord and Savior at age 13, and her faith has remained foundational throughout her life of family, service, teaching, and leadership.

Cache` is passionate about partnering with fellow church members, parents, and families to help children know Jesus Christ, understand His love and saving grace, grow as His disciples, and feel safe, loved, included, and rooted in their church family.

**On Sunday, October 11th the membership will vote to call Cache` Hapner as Director of Family & Children's Ministries during the Morning Worship Service.**

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**Our Bereavement Committee needs more volunteers** to help provide food for our funerals, assist with serving the meals, and with set-up and take-down. This includes both men and women who can assist in any way. We currently have 4 teams, but the numbers are getting smaller. This is an important ministry for our church by helping meet the spiritual and physical needs of the family when a death occurs. We have noticed how a meal helps bring a family together in a time of need. We appreciate anyone who is willing to help. Thank you!

**Rhonda Bass 252-337-5766, Cindy Lewis 252-339-0193**



## FALL REVIVAL WITH REV. KEITH NUCKOLLS

Join us on October 4th – 7th for Fall Revival. Our Guest Speaker will be Rev. Keith Nuckolls, Pastor of Meadow Grove Baptist Church in Hayesville, North Carolina.

On Sunday morning, our Revival begins at the 11:00 Worship hour. Sunday night's fellowship begins with a Covered Dish Meal at 5 PM, followed by Revival at 6 PM. Monday – Wednesday night fellowship begins with a Covered Dish Meal at 6 PM, followed by Revival at 7 PM. There will be special music each night, including Macedonia Baptist Church Choir on Tuesday.

Make plans now to attend!

## SENIOR ADULT SUNDAY

Join us on October 11th for Senior Adult Sunday! There will be special music provided by a choir made up of Senior Adults, a Senior Adult will give a testimony, and special gifts will be presented to all our Senior Adults.



October 11th is also the Sunday for our annual **World Hunger & NC Baptist Children's Homes Offering** which will be taken at the doors at the close of the service.

BAPTIST MEN

**The Baptist Men's Breakfast will be on Sunday, October 18th at 7:30 AM** in the Special Function Room. Gentlemen, please join us for food, fellowship, and devotion!





**Red Box Ministry** – This is a state-wide WMU Ministry effort to provide a Christmas gift to incarcerated women of NC. We are collecting **body lotion**. Acceptable sizes are 8 oz, 9 oz, 10 oz, and 11 oz. Plastic bottles, NO pumps! Place items in the designated bin in the Connecting Corridor. We are collecting through **October 25th**.

**Church Conference will be on Wednesday, October 28th at 7 PM** in the Sanctuary, followed by Prayer Meeting, if time permits. All Committees / Ministry Teams should submit a written report (via email to lbunch@rhbce.org or by dropping it off at the Church Office) no later than 12:00 Noon on the date of Conference.




Youth and Children will follow the regular Wednesday night schedule: 6:45 PM – Vertical Student Ministry (6th - 12th Graders) in the Youth Suite (meal provided), GA's (Girls in 1st - 5th Grades) & RA's (Boys in 1st - 5th Grades) – Special Function Room (meal provided); 7 PM - Mission Friends (3 - 5 year olds) - 2 year olds Classroom.




## SO MUCH PRESSURE

From: devotions4teens.com

**Background Story:** This psalm of praise and declaration was written by David, most likely during his reign as King. David's path to kingship wasn't an easy one. From the time that David was anointed by Samuel (1 Samuel 1:1-13) to the time he took the throne (2 Samuel 2) was roughly around 15 years. During these years of waiting, David spent much of his time fighting battles, hiding in caves, and fleeing for his life.

**Read:** Psalm 139: 1-18

O Lord, you have searched me and known me! [2] You know when I sit down and when I rise up; you discern my thoughts from afar. [3] You search out my path and my lying down and are acquainted with all my ways. [4] Even before a word is on my tongue, behold, O Lord, you know it altogether. [5] You hem me in, behind and before, and lay your hand upon me. [6] Such knowledge is too wonderful for me; it is high; I cannot attain it.

[7] Where shall I go from your Spirit? Or where shall I flee from your presence? [8] If I ascend to heaven, you are there! If I make my bed in Sheol, you are there! [9] If I take the wings of the morning and dwell in the uttermost parts of the sea, [10] even there your hand shall lead me, and your right hand shall hold me. [11] If I say, "Surely the darkness shall cover me, and the light about me be night," [12] even the darkness is not dark to you; the night is bright as the day, for darkness is as light with you.

[13] For you formed my inward parts; you knitted me together in my mother's womb. [14] I praise you, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Wonderful are your works; my soul knows it very well. [15] My frame was not hidden from you, when I was being made in secret, intricately woven in the depths of the earth. [16] Your eyes saw my unformed substance; in your book were written, every one of them, the days that were formed for me, when as yet there was none of them.

[17] How precious to me are your thoughts, O God! How vast is the sum of them! [18] If I would count them, they are more than the sand. I awake, and I am still with you.

**Big Idea:** God is with you and God is for you.

I work around teens all day long watching them navigate relationships, try out for sports and activities, make or not make the grade, apply for college, and the list just keeps on going. The common thread I see is PRESSURE. Pressure on every side. Pressure from their parents. Pressure from their peers. Pressure from their coaches. Pressure from their own expectations. Will they measure up? Will they get picked? Will they be noticed? Will they be ridiculed? Will they matter?

Oh, how I wish I could adequately express God's heart for you today. Read these verses from Psalms 139 over and over and let them wash over you and overtake your heart.

Remember these truths:
God sees YOU!
God knows YOU!
God formed YOU!
God hears YOU!
God is with YOU!
God is for YOU!
God delights in YOU!
God has plans for YOU!

These truths above are not dependent on your performance or if you get the grade, the date, the outcome, or the touchdown. Rest in Him today and feel released from the pressures you carry. You are loved!

**Takeaway Verses:** Isaiah 54:10

" 'Though the mountains be shaken and the hills be removed, yet my unfailing love for you will not be shaken nor my covenant of peace be removed,' says the Lord, who has compassion on you."

**Song For Today:** "I just need U" by TobyMac

# Baptist Women

*From Missions Mosaic, Fall 2026, wmu.com*
*By Donna Fort, a retired Internation Mission Board missionary who served in a variety of discipleship and teaching ministries throughout her missions career in Zimbabwe and South Africa.*

**Prayer**

## The Call to Make Disciples

**WHOSE RESPONSIBILITY IS IT?** When Jesus called His disciples, He told them, "Follow me . . . and I will make you fish for people" (Mark 1:17). As Christians, our call is not to a "job assignment;" our call is to say yes to Jesus, to lovingly and obediently choose to follow Him every day of our lives.

**DISCIPLES FOLLOW AND FISH.** As we spend time with Jesus by reading His Word and praying, the Spirit prompts us to do what He says. Ultimately, Jesus' desire is that we would act on His behalf to reach the lost and introduce them to God. We each have different lifestyles, families, and friends. How we live out our obedience will take different forms. But each of us is called to follow and fish.

Pray your eyes and ears would be spiritually open to recognize those around you who are seeking God so that you might share the gospel with them and play your part in the Spirit leading them to join the family of God. Pray that when God prompts you to reach out to someone, you would obey immediately.

**DISCIPLES ARE PEOPLE OF PRAYER AND ACTION.** Jesus told His disciples, "The harvest is abundant, but the workers are few. Therefore, pray to the Lord of the harvest to send out workers into his harvest" (Luke 10:2). Jesus modeled the importance of prayer in discerning God's will. Once His instructions to us are clear, He expects us to act upon them, not to only keep praying about them.

Jesus' Great Commission to His disciples in Matthew 28:18-20 teaches us how to be disciple makers:

- The importance of baptism as the first step of obedience for a new believer
- How to pray, read, and study God's Word
- How to share their testimony and the gospel with those they know who are lost
- The importance of becoming part of a Bible-believing church
- The importance of sharing with others what they are learning

Disciples obey God's instructions and commands as they learn more from His Word. Pray you would be obedient to God in every area of your life so you would be a good model of how to live as a disciple.

**DISCIPLES MAKE DISCIPLES.** Hebrew parents were expected to teach their children about God through the activities of the day from rising in the morning until bedtime at night. Jewish children were to learn to live in obedience to God and to their parents. For those of us who are parents or grandparents, our children and grandchildren should be among those we disciple. Others of us can consider being a part of discipling children or teens in our extended families, churches, or communities. We may also disciple other people within our circles of influence through the common events of daily life as Jesus modeled in the Gospels.

Jesus never intended discipleship to be merely a 12-week study group that meets once a week. Discipleship is ongoing. It is growing in love and obedience to Christ, modeling this for others, assisting them in areas where they are lacking in knowledge, understanding, or obedience, and then helping them understand their responsibility to do the same for others.

Pray God would reveal to you someone (or a small group) who desires to grow as a believer and would like to be discipled. Pray God would help you discern how to best disciple those He sends you.

Being able to recognize weak areas in our own spiritual development and working to improve them will help us become better disciple makers. The better equipped we are, the more confident and competent we will be as disciple makers. Above all, we must recognize we need to just get out and do it! Practice helps us grow in this area. And don't be surprised at the spiritual insights you gain from the people you disciple as you study God's Word together!

Every generation is one generation away from not knowing, obeying, or worshipping God. Pray you and other believers would do all you can to ensure this generation and the next are well discipled so they may be equipped and obedient to disciple the generation that follows.

## Deacon Team of the Week

9/27/26 – 10/3/26
Carroll Evans, Ruston Howell, Danny Lewis

10/4/26 – 10/10/26
Lee Bass, Allen Nixon, Ellis Tynch

10/11/26 – 10/17/26
Wayne Bunch, David Spruill, Paul Ward

10/18/26 – 10/24/26
J. C. Forehand, Scott Noble, Mike Evans

10/25/26 – 10/31/26
Russell Byrum, Matthew Evans, Phil Smith

## October Deacon Greeters

Senior Adult Building: J. C. Forehand

Sanctuary Main Entrance: Allen Nixon

Connecting Corridor: Chris Turner

Multi-Purpose Main Entrance: Allen Peele

## October Ushers

Adam Bunch, Wayne Copeland, J. C. Forehand,
Allen Nixon, Mike Nixon, Jay White

## October Offering Team

Chris Turner (Lead), Matthew Evans,
J. C. Forehand, Ruston Howell,
Allen Nixon, Allen Peele

## October Counting Committee

Emily Byrum, Jasper Evans, Allen Peele,
Lee & Ruth Jordan

## Stewardship

| Sunday Attendance: | SS | AM | PM |
|---|---|---|---|
| 8/23/26: | 154 | 264 | 66 |
| 8/30/26: | 167 | 243 | 95 |
| 9/6/26: | 155 | 253 | 65 |
| 9/13/26: | 154 | 263 | 97 |
| 9/20/26: | 137 | 288 | 72 |

| Wednesday PM Attendance: | |
|---|---|
| 8/26/26: | 82 |
| 9/2/26: | 71 |
| 9/9/26: | 64 |
| 9/16/26: | 75 |
| 9/23/26: | 71 |

## Edenton-Chowan Food Pantry

The request from RHBC this month is:

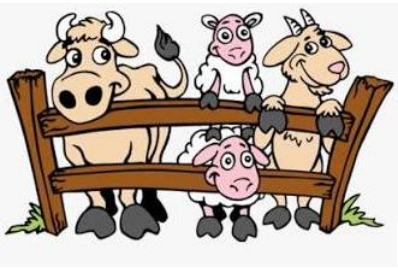



**Mac & Cheese**

**(Family Box)**

# CHILDREN'S PAGE for children of all ages

## Children's Fall Festival Carnival Event



**October 24th from 5 – 7 PM**
**Rocky Hock Baptist Church Campus**
**Petting Zoo, Hayride,**
**Bouncy House, Games**
**(Supper Provided)**








**We are accepting individually wrapped candy donations** for our Fall Festival Event. Chocolate is permissible! A bin is designated in the Connecting Corridor for your contributions. Thank you!



**JOIN THE CHOIR FOR OUR CHRISTMAS MUSICAL!** Any youth or adult who would like to sing in our Christmas Musical is welcome to join us! We will begin practicing on Wednesday, October 14th. The Musical is entitled, ***"Hope in a Manger."***



Rocky Hock Baptist Church
113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, NC 27932

**ADDRESS SERVICE REQUESTED**

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***Check us out on the web at www.rhbce.org***

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*Sundays*:
9:45 AM - Sunday School for all ages
11:00 AM - Morning Worship (Nursery & Children's Church available for 3 year olds - 5th Grade);
Worship Online at www.rhbce.org, our Facebook page, vimeo, and YouTube
6:00 PM - Evening Worship - ***"DEEP DIVE"*** - Adults in Sanctuary, Youth in Youth Suite, Children in Gym

*Wednesdays*:
6:45 PM - Vertical Student Ministries (VSM) - Middle & High School Youth - Youth Suite; Girls in Action (1st-5th Grade Girls) - GA's Room, beside foyer; Royal Ambassadors (1st-5th Grade Boys) – RA's Room, upstairs (meal provided for GA's & RA's in Special Function Room during the school year)
7:00 PM - "**WORSHIP** *Seeds*" for Adults - Sanctuary; Mission Friends (3-5 year olds) - 2 year olds Room

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Allen Nixon, Deacon Chair Cell: 252-312-7966

Linda B. Bunch, Administrative Assistant
lbunch@rhbce.org Office: 252-221-4133

Deborah Long, Custodian
Mary Jo Bass, Treasurer
Trey Bass, Security
Donna Peele, Pianist

Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON